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significant complexity.

- **ELK Stack (Elasticsearch, Logstash, Kibana) and PLG Stack (Promtail, Loki, Grafana)** are essential for aggregating, analysing, and visualising logs and telemetry from all ZTA components (Keycloak, Wazuh, network devices, endpoints).
- **Tailscale** is built on WireGuard and creates a secure mesh network between your devices, simplifying the implementation of zero trust principles. It manages firewall rules and NAT traversal, allowing devices to communicate securely without exposing them to the public internet.
- **Apache Guacamole** offers secure, browser-based remote access to desktops/applications without exposing RDP/SSH directly.

Implementation realities: Beyond the tools

Successfully deploying ZTA with OSS requires careful planning.

Start small: Pilot with a critical application or specific user group. Phased adoption is key.

Define clear policies: ZTA is policy-driven. Explicitly define who (identity), what (device), when, where, and how (application) access is granted before deploying tech.

Integration is crucial: The true power lies in making Keycloak, Wazuh, OpenZiti, and your monitoring stack work together. APIs and event-driven automation are vital.

Invest in skills: Open source demands expertise. Invest in training for your team or consider managed services from OSS-supporting vendors.

Culture shift: ZTA requires buy-in. Communicate the “why” clearly – it’s about enabling secure productivity, not just locking things down.

The open path to resilience

Implementing zero trust isn’t a product purchase — it’s the evolution of security. Open source solutions provide the powerful, flexible, and cost-effective building blocks needed to construct a true zero trust architecture. By leveraging tools like Keycloak for identity, Wazuh and Osquery for posture, OpenZiti for secure networking, and robust monitoring stacks, organisations can build dynamic, context-aware security that meets the challenges of the modern digital landscape. Embrace the open source journey towards ‘never trust, always verify’ – your security posture will be fundamentally stronger for it. **END** 🐧

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